SOP-8

Choosing a Protected Space

Decision Flowchart — Home Front Command Guidelines

When a Red Alert sounds, choose the **highest-priority** option you can reach **within the time available**. Enter and **wait 10 minutes**.

1 Mamad / Mamak / Mamam

Residential, floor, or institutional protected room

- **Close** door tightly, turn handle 90°
- Close external **steel window** AND internal **glass window**
- If double-wing glass: remove wings in advance, store outside room

Preferred choice. If your building has one, always use it.

2 Shelter

Communal building shelter or public shelter

- **Building shelter** — reachable within time to shelter, or via windowless inner stairwell
- **Public shelter** — must be reachable within time to shelter

Best option if no Mamad/Mamak/Mamam in your building.

3 Inner Stairwell

Stairwell without windows or exterior walls

- Stay in the **CENTER** — not top floor, not bottom/entrance floor
- 3+ floor building: stay where at least **2 floors** are above you
- 3-story building: **middle floor** staircase only
- Stay **ON the staircase**, not in the hallway; keep clear of obstacles

Poured concrete structural core — proven to save lives.

4 Inner Room

Innermost space, maximum walls, minimum windows

- Sit close to an **inner wall**, BELOW window line, NOT facing the door
- **Close** all doors and windows; an inner corridor also works
- No **ceramics, porcelain, or glass** that may shatter

5 Last Resort — Open Ground

No building or structure reachable in time

- **Lie flat** on the ground and protect your head with your hands

Also applies if in a caravan/prefab and cannot reach shelter in time.

NOT valid protected spaces: Kitchen · Bathroom · Toilet · Building entrance lobby · Caravans/prefab · Areas with ceramics, porcelain, or glass

DISCLAIMER: Not an official government resource. Use at your own risk. Based on HFC (Pikud HaOref) publications as of 12 Mar 2026. Official guidance: oref.org.il.